LESSON 7

Frère Jacques

An old French round about Brother John, who sleeps through the morning bells. Sing it as a round: a second voice starts two bars later.

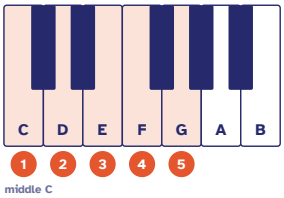
LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen once, then hum along.

THE WOW MOMENT
Din, dan, don: the left hand rings the bells, low C, G, C. Then play it as a **round** with your teacher: two tunes at once make harmony.

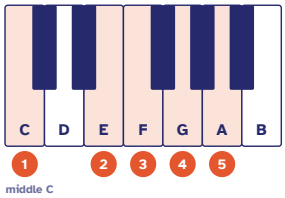
1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it in French, then play it with both hands, then as a round with your teacher.

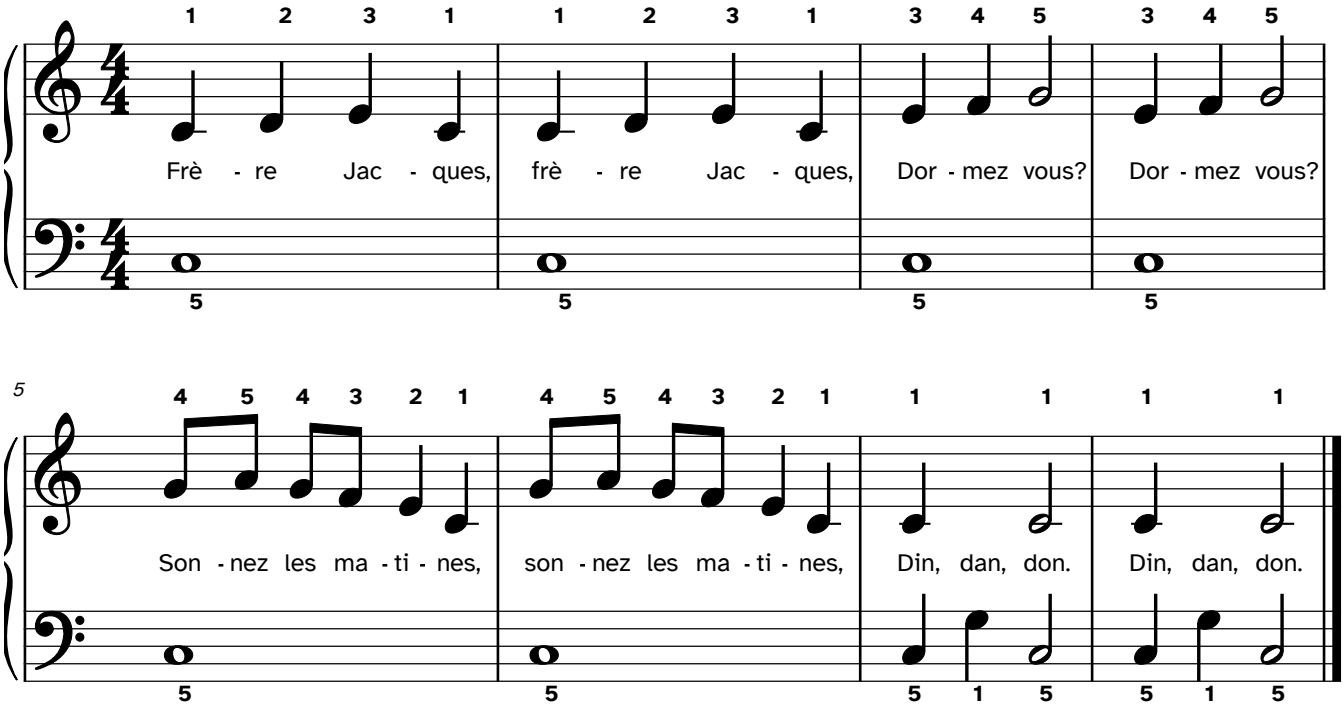
LINES 1–2 · C POSITION



LINE 3 · THE HAND OPENS



Right hand, lines 1–2: the C position, 1 2 3 4 5 from middle C to G.
Line 3: the hand opens; thumb stays on C, so G A G F E C is 4 5 4 3 2 1.
Left hand: 5 on the low C. Play it on beat 1 of every bar and hold it. On *din, dan, don* it rings C, G (thumb), C.



- [ ] Listened and pointed
- [ ] Played it with both hands
- [ ] Played it as a round

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

NEW IN THIS SONG

The root. The left hand plays low C at the start of every bar and holds it. C is the home note the whole song stands on: its **root**. Letters now sit only on the first note of each line.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE TIME

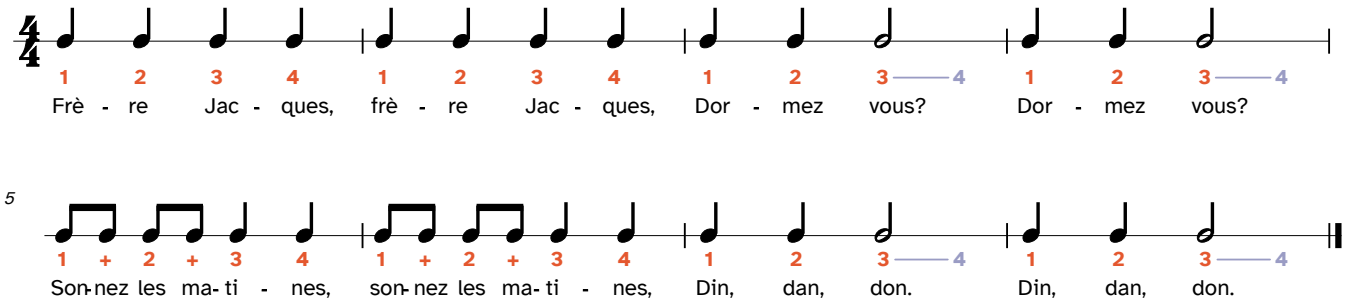
Top 4: four beats in every bar.
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

crotchet: walk — 1 beat

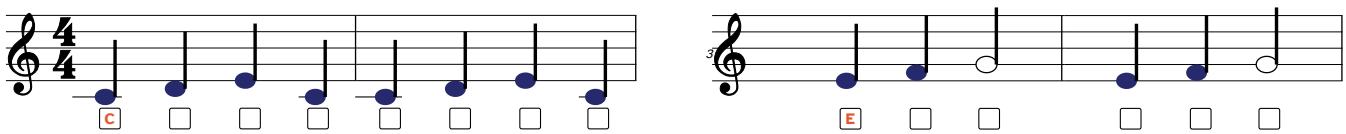
two quavers: run-ning — 1 beat

minim: hold — 2 beats



THE NOTES

Only the first note of each line keeps its letter now. Write the others: count up or down from the one given.



SPOT THE MISTAKE Your teacher plays the song with one wrong note. Put up your hand when you hear it, then find it on the page.
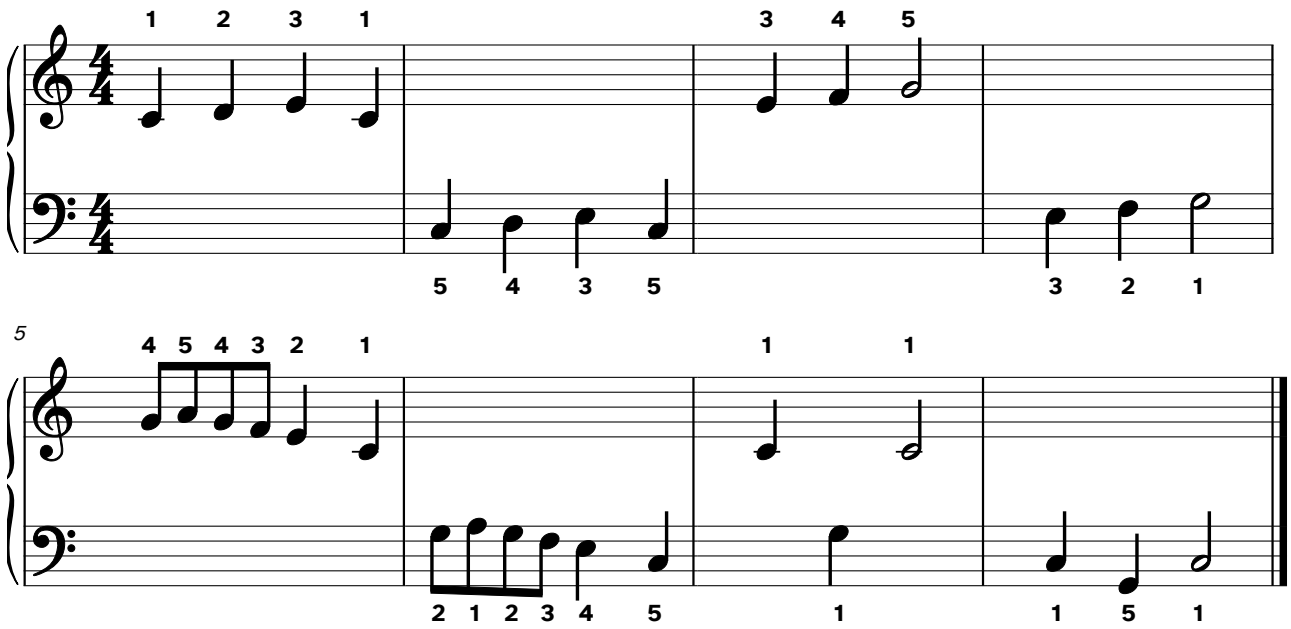
- ☐ **Said it in time**
- ☐ **Clapped and counted**
- ☐ **Wrote the letter names**
- ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

3 Play it

The hands take turns, line by line: the right hand plays, the left hand answers an octave lower.

Right hand: the C position, opening to A on line 3. **Left hand:** the same, an octave lower, 5 on C.

L R BOTH HANDS TAKE TURNS: RIGHT HAND, THEN LEFT HAND AN OCTAVE LOWER



4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can play it as a round

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
Both hands				
Taking turns				

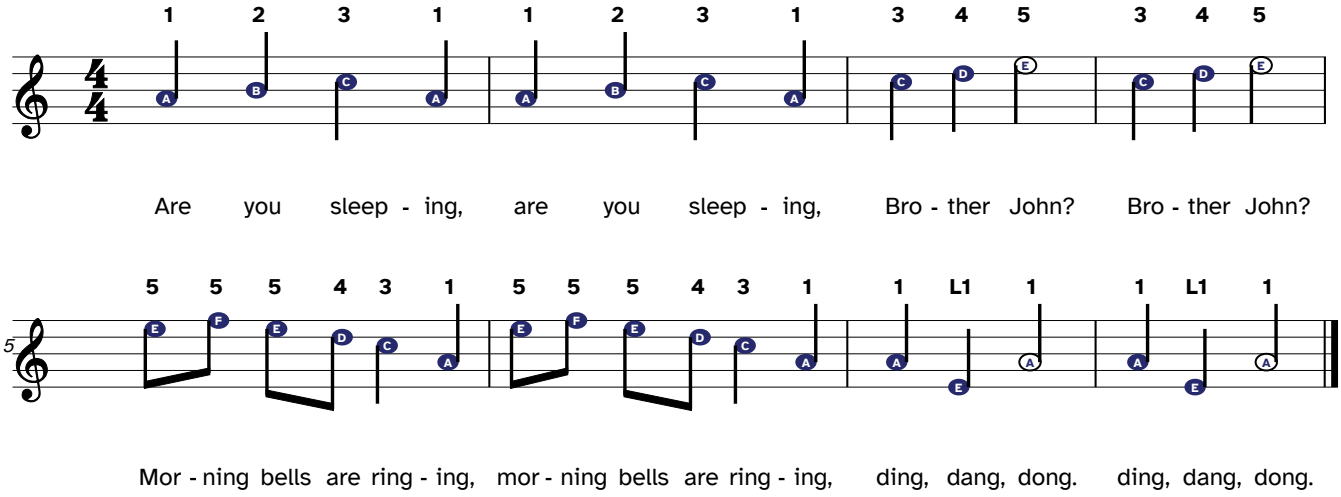
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

The same song by night, the way Mahler heard it; then a slow walk for the left hand, a peek at Lesson 8.

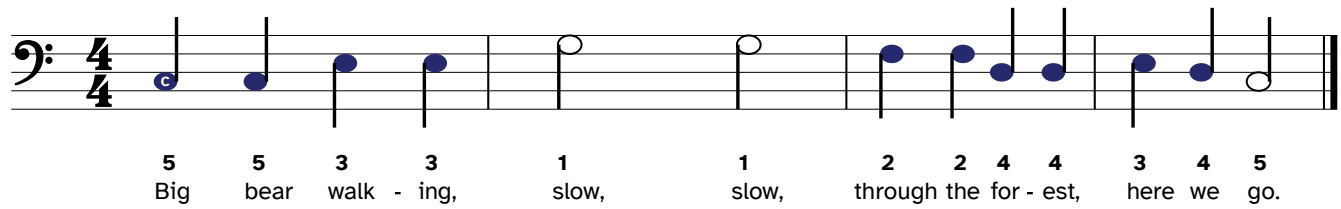
BROTHER JOHN AT NIGHT

Mahler put this song in his First Symphony as a slow, dark march. The trick: start on A instead of C, the same hand shape, and the song turns minor. Passport stamp: Mahler.



BEAR WALK

Slow and heavy, a peek at Lesson 8: the left hand plays the tune, low on the King's staff.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **Sleepy: slow, soft and smooth**
- ☐ **Bouncy: short and light, like a ball**
- ☐ **By night: start on A, the same shape, and hear it turn minor**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Hands take turns, twice
3. Play it with the band
4. Your choice: a tune from this page

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Brother John at Night** ☐ **Played Bear Walk**